

Derelict Rat-Fane of the Maggot Fairy, Ashcan Edition

By Stephen Couchman / Pseudothanatos Press
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Rumors | **1** - Ancients who lived here worshipped a god of prosperity, "rich temples" never discovered. | **2** - Dwarf prospector in the hills overworks the villagers, but since trade broke down he's the only source of coin. | **3** - Drunken friar claimed he was attacked on the road, morning after naught found but bones "so old, grown through with weeds". | **4** - Merchants & pilgrims so bedeviled on local roads they've changed to a different pass, town & abbey are suffering. | **5** - Sir Geoffrey (only armsman) rode out to search for lost villagers months ago, not seen since, charger Adelo found dead off road. | **6** - Dwarf Eegri buys no supplies in town anymore [dead], workers trudge "to his camp" & stagger back w/ [small handfuls of ancient] coin, unless they don't [worked to death, now skeletons]. || **Yvais's wife** = Mela, ruby bracelet w/ 1x **20gp** gem per PC. | "**Abbot**" (**Friar**) = Xacobe, 1x **Potion of Healing**.

Oracular temple of ancient rat-god cult, statues depict crowned plump humanoid rat, wall carvings show rats rewarding worshippers w/ wealth, luck, surviving disease Now filthy, swarming flies, used candle stumps, puddles of maggots, dead bits of vine, haunted by whispers/echoes of prayers, squeaks, screams. Strewn w/ clothes and goods stripped from dozens of pilgrim/trader victims. Charmed townsfolk when encountered labor insensate.

Ankle-deep maggots. 5 corpses in pit being "cleaned" + food scraps, leather. | **Trap** - Deeper basin in center, trip and take bug swarm damage 1d4/round.

SURFACE ENTRANCE is worked unfinished fissure/doorway, concealed by plants. Shovel & bucket on landing.

Filled with religious paraphernalia – rat temple goods + captured habits, books, & 2x deco'd alms boxes (**13gp**). 1x bottle holy water, 1x silver holy symbol, 1x wooden holy symbol, 1x **Potion of Healing**, items value **100gp**.

Trap - vine, surprise 4:6 (bind, 1d4/R), Doors check to free, AC 7, 2hp, 5xp | **Shrieker** 6hp, shriek d3R, WM 3:6

Shrine. "Jolly Fat Rat King" soapstone idol (**125gp**). Travelers' belongings in piles of clothes, gear, trade goods, armor, weapons, items value **100gp**.

2d4 Vine-twined **skeletons** w/ scavenged arms & armor.

Floor = maggoty compost. Glowing fungus for unholy grow-light. Cleaned skeletons bound to pillars by vines. | **Strangle Creeper** - trunk AC6 [13], 25 hp; 8x vines (4x occupied) AC5 [14], 2hp, 1x grab +5 (immobile & 1d4/R, Doors check to free), surprise 4:6, 500xp

2d4 vine-bound **skeletons** lie inert around the room. A charmed **townsfolk** carries a gold offering bowl (**25gp**) containing 13 cursed giant fly eggs, placing eggs in sk. mouths. 1d3 already tended to, rise in 1T | Lair of **Sir Geoffrey** (see Wandering Monsters).

Rat cult inner temple. Carvings of transformation, spying, thieving, spreading plague. Deep maggots, 1:6 chance ea 10x10 = **Giant Maggot Swarm** AC7 [12], 1HD, 1x Swarm (1d2), ML11, 10xp | 1d3+1 **Robber Fly** | Lair of **The Maggot Fairy** AC8, 3HD, 1x Gaze (*charm* 1/day) or 1x touch +2 (1d4 CHA), ML10, summon & command robber flies, skeletons, & *charmed* humans, scry through flies and maggots at will, 500xp | **Treasure Type C** under maggots = 6Kcp+ 4Ksp + 2x 50gp gems + 2x 35gp jewels + 1x slivered short sword & 1 **Potion of Gaseous Form**, hoard value **630gp**

Altar **coffer** w/ effigy of painfully transforming wererat | **Trap** - 1d3x spearpoints (1d6) out of floor when lid disturbed | **Treasure Type B** in coffer = 3Ksp + 2Kgp & 1 Prot. Scroll:Lycanthropes, hoard value **2300gp**.

Devotional statue of The Rat-King. More sinister and domineering pose than outer shrine idol. Brass. **Trap** - Statue is articulated, spinning strike w/ claws, poison (1:6 to still be effective). | **Treasure** - hidden under tongue in statue mouth, **Ring of the Rat-King** = cursed magic ring, wearer into **Wererat** AC7 [12], 3HD, 1 bite +2 (1d4) or wpn, surprise 4:6, normal dam. imm'y, speech OK as beast, *summon* d2 giant rats in d4R, *infect* @ half hp.

Wandering Monsters | **1** - Whispers of the past | **2** - Fly swarms / giant maggots | **3** - 1d3 **Robber Fly** AC6 [13], 2HD, 1 bite +1 (1d8), ML8, surprise 4:6, 20xp | **4** - 1d6 **Skeleton** AC7 [12], 1HD, 1 wpn +0 (1d6), ML12, undead, 10xp | **5** - **Sir Geoffrey of Faladis**, *charmed* human fighter AC2 [17], 2HD, 1 lance (1d6) or 1 sword (1d8) +2, charge 60' for x2 lance dam. on maggot-heap "warhorse Adelo" AC5 [14], 2HD, swarm (save or 2hp from proximity), total 50xp | **6** - (1d4:) Yeoman **Ardwight** / Herbalist **Gretzza** / Ostler **Yvais** / boy **Oskar**, *charmed* Faladis townsfolk AC 9, 1HD, 1 fist +0 (1hp), 5xp. ~♦~

